

TROFIM AGARKOV

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labour Economics • Economics of Education • Applied Microeconometrics

EDUCATION

University of Glasgow

PhD in Economics 2028

MRes in Economics with Distinction 2024

Pompeu Fabra University & Higher School of Economics

BSc in Economics with Honours (Double Degree, Minor in Computer Science) 2022

WORK IN PROGRESS

Exact Parametric Causal Mediation Analysis with a Categorical Mediator

A parametric framework for causal mediation analysis with nominal categorical mediators such as occupation, education, or sector. Building on Imai et al. (2010), I derive closed-form expressions for the direct and indirect effects on the natural outcome scale, with the indirect effect decomposed additively by mediator category, and clarify the relationship to inverse-odds ratio weighting. Simulations show that the approach performs well, particularly when treatment–mediator interactions are present.

The Cost of a Gap Year: Education Delay and Career Outcomes

This paper estimates the association between taking a gap year before higher education and early-career earnings in the UK, using the *Next Steps* cohort linked to administrative school records. I compare students who defer entry with those who enrol immediately, using OLS, matching, and sensitivity analyses. I find that gap-year participation is associated with lower earnings at ages 25 and 32, with the penalty declining over time. Effects are largest for unplanned and non-labour-market gaps, while labour-market-oriented gaps show little effect, suggesting that the implications of a gap year depend partly on its purpose and structure.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, University of Glasgow

Access to Higher Education: Economics 2026 – 2027

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Glasgow

Bayesian Data Analysis (PG) 2025 – 2026

Introductory Economics (UG) 2024 – 2026

Microeconomic Analysis (UG) 2023 – 2026

Introductory Statistics (UG) 2024 – 2025

Market Failures and Mechanism Design (UG) 2025

Teaching Assistant, Higher School of Economics

Dynamical Systems in Economics (UG) 2021

Methods of Optimisation (UG) 2020

Linear Algebra (UG) 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

HSE International Laboratory of Game Theory and Decision Making

Research Intern (*Russian College Admissions System*) 2020 – 2021

Research Assistant (*Parsing Data on College Admissions in Russia*) Summer 2019

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2027:

2026: 1st Minorities in Economics Workshop, University of Bristol; Scottish Economic Society Annual Conference, University of Glasgow; PhD Reading Group, University of Glasgow.

2025: PhD Reading Group, University of Glasgow.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Excellence in Research Engagement and Citizenship, University of Glasgow	2026
Associate Fellowship, Recognising Excellence in Teaching, University of Glasgow	2025
ONS/ESRC Accredited Researcher	2025
Economics Scholarship (MRes+PhD), University of Glasgow	2022
Double Degree Scholarship, Higher School of Economics	2021

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Economics PhD Reading Group Coordinator, University of Glasgow	2025 – 2027
Economics PhD Representative, University of Glasgow	2024 – 2027
Volunteer, Economics Outreach Day for High School Students, University of Glasgow	2024, 2026

SKILLS

Programming	Stata, R, Python, LaTeX
Data	UK secure administrative microdata (UK Data Service Secure Lab)
Languages	English (Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate), Russian (Native)

REFERENCES

Prof. Anwen Zhang

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Dr. Santiago Montoya-Blandon

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